

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP World History: Modern Free-Response Practice Exam 4

APWH-SAQ4-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Transoceanic Interconnections

Period: c. 1450–1750

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Mixed Historical Reasoning

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source 1: Historian Elena Marques, “Fortresses and Violence in the Early Modern Indian Ocean,” modern historical interpretation, 2020.

“Portuguese expansion in the Indian Ocean marked a significant break from earlier commercial patterns. Armed ships, fortified ports, and cartaz pass systems inserted European military power into maritime trade. Even when Portuguese officials could not control all commerce, they changed the political risks of oceanic exchange.”

Source 2: Historian Arjun Sen, “Asian Merchants and Maritime Continuity,” modern historical interpretation, 2021.

“The arrival of the Portuguese did not erase older Indian Ocean commercial systems. Gujarati, Arab, Malay, Persian, and Chinese merchants continued to dominate many routes because they possessed local knowledge, credit networks, monsoon expertise, and long-standing commercial relationships.”

- (a) Identify one difference between the two historians’ interpretations of Portuguese activity in the Indian Ocean.
- (b) Describe one specific historical development that could be used to support one of the interpretations.
- (c) Explain one way Indian Ocean trade during c. 1450–1750 was similar to or different from Atlantic trade during the same period.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a clear difference between the interpretations, such as Source 1 emphasizing disruption through Portuguese military power while Source 2 emphasizes continuity of Asian merchant networks.
- (b) 1 point: Describes a relevant development, such as Portuguese seizure of ports, construction of forts, the cartaz pass system, armed trading ships, continued Gujarati or Arab merchant activity, monsoon-based trade, or continued exchange through Muslim, Hindu, and Chinese merchants.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid similarity or difference with Atlantic trade, such as greater European settler colonization and plantation slavery in the Atlantic, continued Asian merchant dominance in much of the Indian Ocean, the role of maritime empires, or the use of coerced labor and silver in Atlantic systems.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should show that Portuguese entry into the Indian Ocean both changed and failed to fully replace existing systems. The best responses use specific evidence rather than simply saying “Europeans controlled trade.” For part (c), strong answers compare systems of maritime commerce, political control, labor, or merchant participation in the Indian Ocean and Atlantic worlds.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ4-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Open letter from a workers’ committee in Gdańsk, Poland, to employees in state factories, 1981. This excerpt is original but modeled on labor statements from communist Eastern Europe.

“We are told that the state speaks in the name of workers, yet workers are not permitted to speak freely in their own workplaces. A union that depends on the party cannot defend those who stand at the machines, repair the ships, and wait in lines for bread. We do not call for foreign rule, nor do we reject social justice. We ask for honest representation, the right to publish our views, and negotiations conducted without threats.”

(a) Identify the likely purpose of the open letter.

(b) Explain how the source reflects one challenge faced by communist governments during the Cold War.

(c) Explain one limitation of the source as evidence for the views of all people living under communist governments in Eastern Europe.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a plausible purpose, such as gaining support for an independent union, criticizing party-controlled labor organizations, demanding free expression, pressuring authorities to negotiate, or mobilizing factory workers.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant Cold War-era challenge, such as shortages, limits on political expression, tension between communist ideology and worker dissatisfaction, opposition movements, legitimacy problems, or state control over unions and media.

(c) 1 point: Explains a valid limitation, such as the letter representing organized workers rather than party officials, rural populations, military leaders, intellectuals, women, or all citizens; or noting that an opposition document may emphasize grievances while downplaying support for the regime.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should use the source’s point of view and purpose. The workers’ committee challenges the state’s claim to represent labor, but it frames its demands in terms of representation and social justice rather than support for foreign domination. Strong answers should connect the source to broader Cold War tensions inside communist states without assuming that every Eastern European citizen held the same views.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ4-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Consequences of Industrialization

Period: c. 1750–1900

Theme: TEC — Technology and Innovation

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Plain-text version of a steamship company timetable chart, printed in London, 1888.

Estimated Passenger and Mail Travel Times from London

Route Approximate Travel Time in 1840 Approximate Travel Time in 1888

London to Bombay 3 to 4 months by sailing ship 18 to 21 days by steamship and canal route

London to Cape Town 8 to 10 weeks by sailing ship 20 to 24 days by steamship

London to Shanghai 4 to 5 months by sailing ship 35 to 40 days by steamship and coaling stops

London to Buenos Aires 7 to 9 weeks by sailing ship 25 to 30 days by steamship

Notes printed below the chart: “Regular steamship service depends on coaling stations, telegraph offices, canal routes, and port agreements.”

- (a) Identify one technological or infrastructural development reflected in the chart.
- (b) Explain one way the developments shown in the chart contributed to imperial expansion or global economic integration during c. 1750–1900.
- (c) Explain one way faster transportation and communication could have affected migration or labor patterns during c. 1750–1900.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a valid development, such as steamships, canal routes, coaling stations, telegraph offices, port agreements, or more regular long-distance transportation.
- (b) 1 point: Explains how these developments contributed to imperial expansion or economic integration, such as faster movement of officials, troops, mail, migrants, raw materials, manufactured goods, financial information, or commercial orders across long distances.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid effect on migration or labor, such as increased long-distance migration, movement of contract workers, easier circulation of merchants and officials, faster recruitment for overseas labor, or stronger links between colonial labor markets and global demand.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect the chart’s travel-time changes to broader nineteenth-century transformations. The key is not simply that travel became faster, but that steamships, canals, coaling stations, and telegraphs made empires and global markets easier to coordinate. Strong answers may connect transportation improvements to migration, indentured labor, settler movement, merchant mobility, or administrative control.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-DBQ4-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Global Conflict

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which World War I changed relationships between imperial states and colonial peoples from 1914 to 1930.

Document 1

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Letter from an Indian soldier serving with British forces in France to his brother in Punjab, 1915.

Source Type: Personal letter.

“We have crossed seas I never imagined and now fight in cold mud for the King-Emperor. The officers praise our courage, and men from many lands stand beside us. Yet I wonder whether loyalty shown in battle will be remembered when the war ends. If India gives blood and money, should India not also receive honor and a greater voice in her own affairs?”

Sourcing cues: Colonial soldier writing privately during wartime; expresses loyalty and expectation of political recognition.

Document 2

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Circular from a French colonial governor to district officers in West Africa, 1916.

Source Type: Administrative circular.

“The Republic requires additional men for labor battalions, transport services, and military support. Chiefs should be reminded that loyal cooperation will bring favor after victory. Recruitment must be energetic but orderly, and reports should emphasize the honor of defending civilization against German aggression.”

Sourcing cues: Colonial administrative perspective; reveals wartime demands on colonial subjects and official language of loyalty.

Document 3

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Wartime service summary compiled by an imperial statistics office, 1919.

Source Type: Plain-text data table.

Selected Colonial and Overseas Contributions during World War I

Region / Population Group	Type of Service Described
British India	Combat troops, laborers, money, supplies
French West Africa	Soldiers, porters, agricultural production
North Africa	Soldiers and laborers in European theaters
China	Labor corps for transport, repair, and logistics

Caribbean colonies Volunteers, funds, and shipping labor
Pacific island communities Labor, local defense, and resource supply

Note on the table: The figures were presented by imperial governments as evidence of empire-wide loyalty and shared sacrifice.

Sourcing cues: Official statistical framing; highlights contributions but may understate coercion, casualties, or dissent.

Document 4

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Description of a British recruitment poster distributed in northern India, 1917.

Source Type: Described poster.

The poster shows a uniformed Indian soldier standing beside a British officer under a banner reading “Serve with Honor.” Behind them are images of the Union Jack, a village elder blessing departing recruits, and a battlefield where Indian cavalry charge forward. At the bottom, the text promises pay, family allowances, and respect for loyal service.

Sourcing cues: Recruitment propaganda; designed to persuade colonial subjects by appealing to honor, loyalty, masculinity, and material benefits.

Document 5

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Petition from Egyptian nationalist leaders to British officials, 1919, Cairo.

Source Type: Political petition.

“During the war, Egypt’s fields, railways, animals, and laborers were placed at the disposal of the British army. We were told that the struggle was for liberty and the rights of nations. We therefore request recognition of Egypt’s right to send representatives abroad and to determine its own political future without military occupation.”

Sourcing cues: Nationalist elite petition after wartime mobilization; uses wartime rhetoric of self-determination against imperial control.

Document 6

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Declaration by Korean students after demonstrations against Japanese rule, 1919, Seoul.

Source Type: Student declaration.

“The world speaks now of justice among nations. We do not seek revenge against the Japanese people, but we reject rule that denies our language, associations, and dignity. If small nations in Europe may claim self-determination, Korea must not be treated as an exception in Asia.”

Sourcing cues: Anti-colonial student perspective; invokes global postwar language to challenge Japanese imperial rule.

Document 7

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Memoir excerpt by a Senegalese veteran of French service, written in 1928, Dakar.

Source Type: Memoir excerpt.

“In France, we learned that the empire needed us when danger came. Some officers spoke to us as comrades; others treated us as children. When we returned, medals did not protect us from taxes or insults. Still, the journey changed many of us. We had seen the weakness of Europeans and heard new words about rights.”

Sourcing cues: Veteran’s retrospective account; emphasizes changed expectations and contradictions of imperial service.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which World War I changed relationships between imperial states and colonial peoples from 1914 to 1930. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning, such as arguing that the war intensified imperial demands while encouraging colonial subjects to make stronger claims for rights, representation, and self-determination.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader historical context relevant to imperialism and World War I, such as nineteenth-century imperial expansion, colonial labor and taxation, European rivalries, wartime mobilization, Wilsonian self-determination, the Russian Revolution, the League of Nations, or postwar nationalist movements.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point by accurately using the content of at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points by using at least six documents to support an argument about wartime mobilization, colonial military service, propaganda, labor demands, postwar nationalist claims, self-determination, or changing perceptions of European authority.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by using at least one specific piece of relevant outside evidence not found in the documents, such as the Amritsar massacre, the May Fourth Movement, the Wafd Party, the mandate system, the Balfour Declaration, Pan-African Congresses, Ho Chi Minh’s appeal at Versailles, the Rowlatt Acts, or wartime African troop recruitment.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. Effective examples include explaining why recruitment posters appealed to honor and benefits, why imperial statistics emphasized loyalty, why nationalist petitions used wartime language of liberty, or why veterans’ memories highlighted contradictions in imperial rule.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a more complex understanding of imperial relationships after World War I. This may include explaining both continuity and change, showing that imperial rule often persisted even as colonial expectations changed, comparing different empires, or analyzing how wartime loyalty could become a basis for anti-imperial claims.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ could argue that World War I did not immediately end imperial rule, but it changed relationships between imperial states and colonial peoples by increasing colonial military and labor demands while giving colonized groups new arguments for rights and self-determination.

Documents 1, 2, 3, and 4 can support arguments about imperial mobilization and wartime loyalty.

Documents 5, 6, and 7 can support arguments about postwar nationalism, disappointment, and changed perceptions of empire. Outside evidence could include Amritsar, May Fourth, the Wafd Party, the mandate system, Ho Chi Minh at Versailles, or Pan-African Congresses. Strong sourcing might analyze propaganda purpose, official statistical framing, nationalist use of wartime rhetoric, and veterans’ retrospective perspective.

Expected Points:

7

APWH-LEQ4-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 5 — Revolutions

Period: c. 1750–1900

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From c. 1750 to 1900, nationalism became an increasingly powerful political force. In some places it helped create new states, while in others it challenged existing empires or reshaped older ideas about monarchy, citizenship, and sovereignty.

Evaluate the extent to which nationalism caused political change in the period c. 1750 to 1900.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which nationalism caused political change from c. 1750 to 1900. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning that weighs nationalism against other causes such as Enlightenment ideas, economic change, imperial crisis, military conflict, or social inequality.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader context relevant to nationalism, such as Enlightenment political thought, Atlantic revolutions, the spread of print culture, Napoleonic expansion, imperial decline, industrialization, liberalism, romanticism, or growing challenges to dynastic rule.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point by identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as Latin American independence movements, German unification, Italian unification, Balkan nationalism, the Greek War of Independence, the Haitian Revolution, the French Revolution, or nationalist resistance within the Ottoman, Austrian, or Russian empires. Earns 2 points by using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about causation.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by using causation to explain how nationalism contributed to political change and how other causes also mattered. Strong responses might explain that nationalism mobilized populations, legitimized new states, challenged dynastic empires, or redefined sovereignty, while also noting the importance of war, elite leadership, economic interests, or foreign intervention.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced understanding of nationalism and political change. This may include explaining that nationalism could be revolutionary or conservative, that it unified some peoples while fragmenting empires, that elite and popular nationalism could differ, or that nationalism interacted with liberalism, imperialism, and racial ideologies.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should make a clear causal argument about nationalism rather than simply describing several independence movements. Useful evidence might include Latin American independence, German and Italian unification, Balkan independence movements, the Greek War of Independence, the French Revolution, the Haitian Revolution, and nationalist challenges to multiethnic empires. Strong answers should explain how nationalism caused political change while also evaluating other causes, such as imperial weakness, war, Enlightenment ideas, social inequality, or elite political strategy.

Expected Points:

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APWH-FRQ4

· APWH-SAQ4-001: Unit 4 — Transoceanic Interconnections; c. 1450–1750; Indian Ocean world involving Portuguese Estado da Índia, Gujarati, Arab, Malay, Persian, and Chinese merchants with comparison to Atlantic trade; secondary text source with two modern historians; source perspectives contrast Portuguese military disruption through forts, armed ships, and cartaz passes with continuity of Asian merchant networks, monsoon knowledge, credit, and local commercial relationships; historical development is early modern Indian Ocean maritime competition and continuity; reasoning path analyzes continuity versus change and compares Indian Ocean and Atlantic maritime systems; misconception targeted: Portuguese arrival instantly gave Europeans full control of Indian Ocean trade.

· APWH-SAQ4-002: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization; c. 1900–present; Eastern Europe / Poland under communist rule; primary text source is an original open letter from a workers' committee in Gdańsk to state factory workers; source perspective is organized labor opposition challenging party-controlled unions while using language of worker representation and social justice; historical development is Cold War-era dissent within communist states, labor organization, censorship, shortages, and legitimacy crisis; reasoning path focuses on purpose, political challenge, and limits of representativeness; misconception targeted: communist governments always had unified worker support because they claimed to rule in the name of labor.

· APWH-SAQ4-003: Unit 6 — Consequences of Industrialization; c. 1750–1900; transregional steamship routes linking London to Bombay, Cape Town, Shanghai, and Buenos Aires; non-text source type is a plain-text steamship company timetable chart; visual/data/map pattern compares 1840 and 1888 travel times and notes steamships, canal routes, coaling stations, telegraph offices, and port agreements; historical development is industrial transportation and communications infrastructure accelerating imperial administration, commerce, migration, and labor mobility; reasoning path is causation from transport and communication technologies to global integration and migration effects; misconception targeted: nineteenth-century globalization depended only on factories rather than transport, communications, and infrastructure.

· APWH-DBQ4-001: Unit 7 — Global Conflict; c. 1900–present; British India, French West Africa, North Africa, China, Caribbean colonies, Pacific island communities, Egypt, Korea under Japanese rule, Senegal, and imperial Europe; DBQ topic is World War I changing relationships between imperial states and colonial peoples from 1914 to 1930; document types include Indian soldier letter, French colonial governor circular, imperial service data table, described British recruitment poster in India, Egyptian nationalist petition, Korean student declaration, and Senegalese veteran memoir; document perspectives include colonial soldiers, imperial administrators, official statisticians, recruitment propagandists, nationalist elites, anti-colonial students, and colonial veterans; main argument paths include wartime mobilization, labor and troop extraction, imperial propaganda, loyalty claims, postwar self-determination, nationalist disappointment, and changed perceptions of European authority; outside evidence possibilities include Amritsar massacre, May Fourth Movement, Wafd Party, mandate system, Balfour Declaration, Pan-African Congresses, Ho Chi Minh at Versailles, Rowlatt Acts, and African troop recruitment; sourcing opportunities include private soldier uncertainty, administrative recruitment pressure, official loyalty framing, propaganda appeals, nationalist use of wartime rhetoric, and veteran retrospective critique.

· APWH-LEQ4-001: Unit 5 — Revolutions; c. 1750–1900; transregional evidence from Latin America, Europe, the Balkans, the Ottoman Empire, Austrian Empire, Russian Empire, Haiti, France, Germany, Italy, and Greece; LEQ topic is nationalism as a cause of political change; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include Latin American independence, German unification, Italian unification, Balkan nationalism, Greek War of Independence, Haitian Revolution, French Revolution, nationalist resistance within multiethnic

empires, print culture, liberalism, and romanticism; complexity path weighs nationalism against Enlightenment ideas, war, imperial weakness, social inequality, elite strategy, liberalism, and economic change while distinguishing unifying nationalism from separatist nationalism; misconception targeted: nationalism always produced the same kind of political change or acted independently from other revolutionary forces.